

Japan Electronic Components: July MOF trade data (MLCC): mom increase in volume/value likely driven by smartphone seasonality

According to Ministry of Finance (MOF) trade statistics for July, announced on August 28, the average export price for MLCCs was down -1% mom, while export volume was up +20%, and export value was up +19%. On a yoy basis, these figures were +21%/+4%/+25%. We assume the mom increase in volume and value was driven by seasonality for North American smartphone applications. We believe the mom decline in average price reflects an increase in smartphone applications, which use many small products (mix impact), and we think the yoy rate of change (where the growth rate in price and value is larger than the increase in volume) clearly indicates strength in AI/DC applications and a recovery in automotive applications.

We maintain our Buy ratings on Murata Mfg. (on CL), Taiyo Yuden, and TDK. While the recent share price trend appears to be waiting for the next catalyst, we expect share prices to regain upward momentum as strong fundamentals are confirmed heading into 2027. 2H FY3/26 will be a phase where earnings leverage kicks in, driven by a combination of favorable conditions such as mix improvement, higher utilization rates (increased production volume), pricing effects, and maximum possible inventory buildup. In particular, we expect upward revisions to full-year earnings guidance at interim results from Murata Mfg. (its second revision), whose 2Q assumptions appear conservative, and from TDK, which has not revised up its full-year guidance. We believe that attention on the shares will increase again as visibility improves heading into FY3/27.

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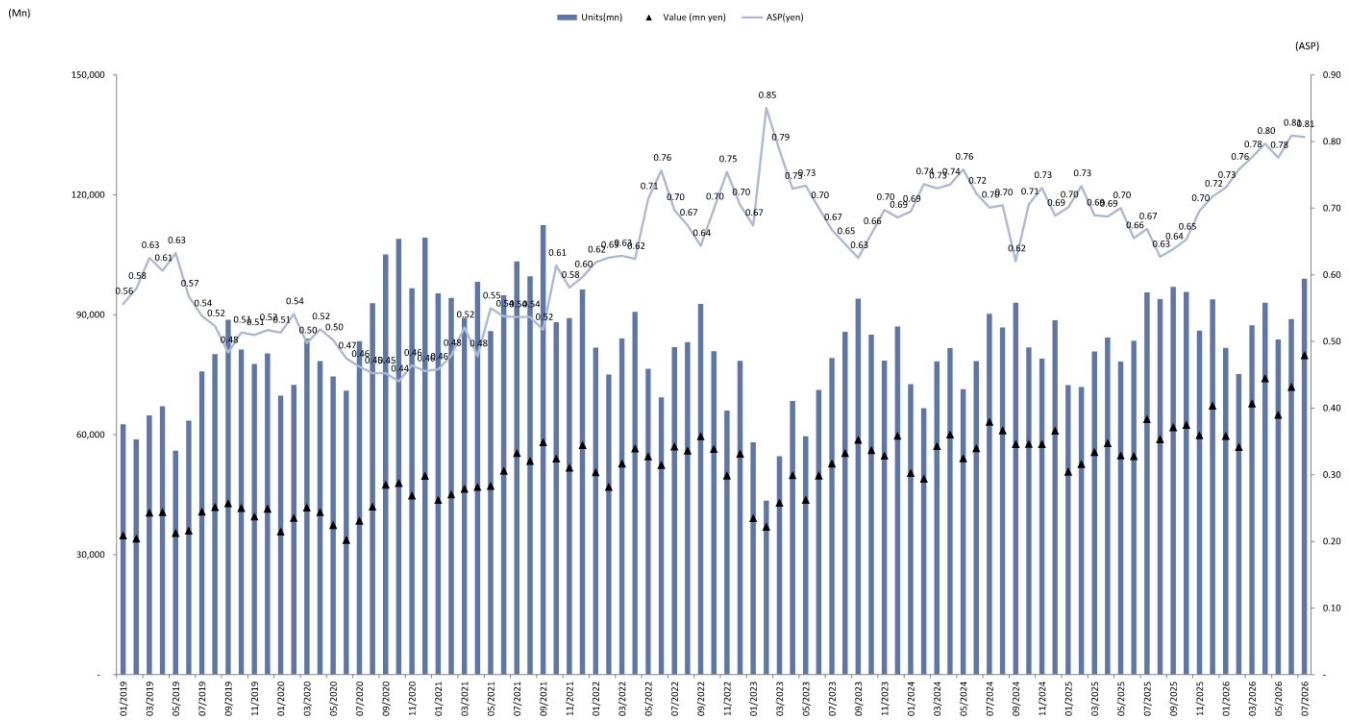
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Exhibit 1: MLCC export volume and average export price (ASP)

Source: Ministry of Finance

Price target risks and methodology**Price Target Risks and Methodology – Murata Mfg.**

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,900. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Taiyo Yuden

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Taiyo Yuden with a 12-month price target of ¥21,300. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (our TP implies FY3/29E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected smartphone demand, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of

¥4,900. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 27X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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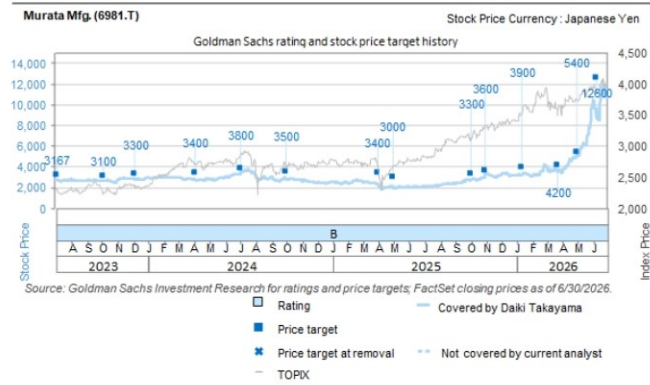
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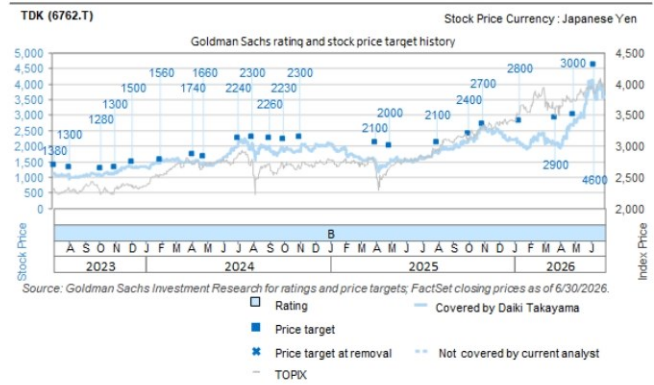
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	Buy	Hold	Sell
	65%	59%	43%

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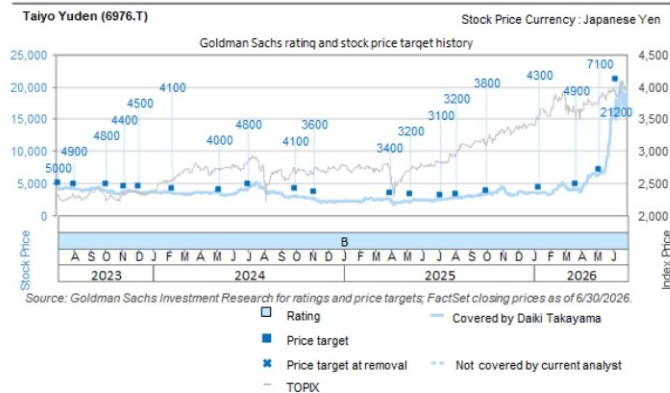
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Target price history table(s)

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Aug-26	21,300	11,165
08-Jun-26	21,200	14,975
08-May-26	7,100	6,663
23-Mar-26	4,900	3,926
12-Jan-26	4,300	3,405
02-Oct-25	3,800	3,382
05-Aug-25	3,200	2,841
07-Jul-25	3,100	2,488
09-May-25	3,200	2,202
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,467
07-Nov-24	3,600	2,781
01-Oct-24	4,100	3,081
02-Jul-24	4,800	4,105

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	12,900	7,416
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-May-24	4,000	3,643
07-Feb-24	4,100	3,431
06-Dec-23	4,500	3,627
07-Nov-23	4,400	3,695
04-Oct-23	4,800	3,963

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	4,900	3,008
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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